Pretend you are my Data Analytics instructor, I am transitioning from a non-tech career to a technical career and I need tutoring with my SQL skills

Got it — I'll treat this like you've just walked into office hours on week one, and we're going to build you up *properly*.

First — mindset shift (this matters more than syntax)

You are **not learning SQL to memorize commands**.
You are learning SQL to **answer questions with data**.

Think of SQL as:

> "A language for asking a database very specific questions."

🧠 What SQL really is (plain English)

Imagine a giant Excel spreadsheet with millions of rows.

SQL lets you say things like:

- "Show me all customers from Chicago"
- "Count how many orders we had last month"
- "What's the average salary in each department?"

🧱 The Core Building Block: `SELECT`

This is your foundation. Everything starts here.

```
SELECT column_name
```

SQL

👉 Translation:

> "Go to this table and show me this column."

Example

Table: `employees`

id	name	department	salary
1	Alex	Sales	60000
2	Jordan	IT	80000
3	Sam	Sales	65000

Query:

```sql
SELECT name
FROM employees;
```

SQL

👉 Result:

```
Alex
Jordan
Sam
```

🔍 Filtering Data: `WHERE`

Now we get *specific*.

```
SELECT *
```

SQL

👉 Translation:

> "Give me everything, but only for employees in Sales."

📊 Aggregation (this is where analysts shine)

These answer business questions.

Count rows:

```
SELECT COUNT(*)
FROM employees;
```

SQL

Average salary:

```
SELECT AVG(salary)
FROM employees;
```

SQL

🧩 Grouping (VERY important for analytics)

```
SELECT department, AVG(salary)
FROM employees
GROUP BY department;
```

👉 Translation:

> "For each department, calculate the average salary."

🚨 Common Beginner Mistake

A lot of beginners think:

> "I need to learn everything before I can use SQL."

No.

You really just need to master:

1. `SELECT`
2. `WHERE`
3. `GROUP BY`
4. `JOIN` (we'll get here soon)

That's like **80% of real-world analytics work**.

🧪 Let's make this interactive

I want to see how you're thinking.

Try this:

You have a table called `orders`:

order_id	customer	amount	status
1	John	100	shipped
2	Sarah	200	pending
3	John	150	shipped

❓ Question:

Write a query to:

> Show all orders where the status is "shipped"

Type your answer — don't worry about being perfect.
I'll correct you like a real instructor 👍